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The Fusion Opportunity.

A market intelligence report and brand activation strategy
for American Fusion Inc. (OTC: AMFN)

PREPARED BY · BOTMAKERS INC.

MAY 2026 · CONFIDENTIAL CLIENT DELIVERABLE



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THE FUSION OPPORTUNITY

Market Intelligence Report and Brand Activation Strategy for American Fusion Inc. (OTC: AMFN)

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Part I — Executive Summary 1.1 The Thesis 1.2 The Five Findings 1.3 The Decision Before You

Part II — Market Analysis 2.1 The Fusion Energy Market: Size, Velocity, and Inflection 2.2 The AI Power Crisis: Demand Tailwind of a Generation 2.3 The Defense Energy Mandate: Executive Order 14299 and Beyond 2.4 The Capital Landscape: Where the Money Is Going 2.5 The Aneutronic Sub-Category: Your Specific Battlefield

Part III — Competitive Landscape 3.1 The Top Six American Fusion Players 3.2 Side-by-Side Capability Matrix 3.3 The Two-Speed Industry: Funded Incumbents vs. Emerging Challengers 3.4 Where American Fusion Fits (Honestly)

Part IV — Brand Presence Audit 4.1 Methodology 4.2 Channel-by-Channel Findings 4.3 The IBN Dependency: A Diagnostic 4.4 Executive Digital Footprint 4.5 Search Visibility and Narrative Capture 4.6 Comparative Scorecard

Part V — The Strategic Gap 5.1 The Three Costs of Invisibility 5.2 The Five Audiences Currently Underserved 5.3 What Helion and Commonwealth Are Doing That You Aren't 5.4 The Closing Window

Part VI — The Strategy 6.1 Strategic Pillars 6.2 Phase 1 — Foundation (Days 1–14) 6.3 Phase 2 — Content Engine (Days 15–60) 6.4 Phase 3 — Amplification and Community (Days 60–90) 6.5 Phase 4 — Authority and Compounding (Months 4–12) 6.6 The Content Pillar System 6.7 The Channel Playbook 6.8 Founder-Led Narrative Architecture

Part VII — Measurement and Accountability 7.1 90-Day Targets 7.2 12-Month Targets 7.3 Leading vs. Lagging Indicators 7.4 Reporting Cadence

Part VIII — Implementation Plan 8.1 BotMakers Engagement Model 8.2 Roles and Responsibilities 8.3 Timeline and Milestones 8.4 Risk Register

Part IX — Strategic Recommendations 9.1 Three Things We Will Push Back On 9.2 Three Things You Must Decide 9.3 The Ask

Appendices A. Sources and Citations B. Glossary of Industry Terms C. Sample Content Concepts D. Competitor Post Analysis

PART I — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.1 The Thesis

American Fusion Inc. is operating in the most capital-rich, narrative-hungry, and consequential energy market in modern history — and is doing so with zero owned audience, zero coordinated brand voice, and zero digital footprint capable of supporting the company's ambitions in defense procurement, capital markets, talent acquisition, or commercial offtake.

This is not a marketing problem. This is a **valuation problem**, a **procurement problem**, and a **competitive positioning problem** wearing a marketing costume.

The fusion industry is undergoing a once-in-a-generation inflection. Global electricity consumption from data centers is projected to roughly double from 485 TWh in 2025 to approximately 950 TWh by 2030. AI-specific demand is set to triple over the same period. The U.S. data center share alone is expected to grow by 130%. The fusion energy market itself, by aggressive private-sector estimates, will scale from \$40–80 billion by 2035 to over \$350 billion by 2050.

Capital is flowing in unprecedented volumes. Commonwealth Fusion Systems raised \$863 million in Series B2 in August 2025. Helion Energy was valued at \$5.4 billion after its \$425 million Series F in January 2025. Microsoft signed the world's first fusion power purchase agreement with Helion. Google committed to a 200 MW PPA with Commonwealth. Reports indicate OpenAI is in advanced talks with Helion for up to 50 GW by 2035.

In parallel, the U.S. Department of Defense has formally mandated nuclear power deployment at military installations. Executive Order 14299 requires an operational nuclear reactor at a domestic U.S. military installation by September 30, 2028. The Defense Innovation Unit's Advanced Nuclear Power for Installations (ANPI) program has named eight companies eligible for contracts. The Army's Janus Program has selected nine sites. These are publicly identified buyers with mandated timelines.

American Fusion is competing for the same buyers, the same capital, the same talent, and the same narrative oxygen as Commonwealth Fusion Systems, Helion, TAE Technologies, and General Fusion. The technology gap is debatable. The visibility gap is not. Commonwealth Fusion Systems has 30,663 LinkedIn followers. Helion has 26,822. American Fusion has zero.

This report quantifies the gap, diagnoses the causes, and proposes a 90-day Foundation, Content, and Amplification strategy followed by a 9-month Authority phase designed to position American Fusion as a recognized voice in the AI-energy, defense-energy, and capital markets conversations that will determine the next five years of the company's trajectory.

1.2 The Five Findings

Finding 1: The market is real, the window is open, and the timing is now. The IEA projects data center electricity demand will roughly double globally by 2030. Capital investment in major hyperscaler infrastructure exceeded \$400 billion in 2025 and is projected to grow 75% in 2026. Executive Order 14299 has hard-wired a federal nuclear-deployment deadline into the calendar. American Fusion's strategic positioning around AI workloads, defense applications, and modular fusion is correctly aligned with the strongest demand vectors in the energy industry.

Finding 2: The competitive set is publishing aggressively, and American Fusion is not. Commonwealth Fusion Systems employs a dedicated Manager of Social Media Strategy, has hired against a VP of Marketing and Communications role and a Head of Digital role, and operates a documented content engine across LinkedIn, X, YouTube, and Instagram. Helion's CEO David Kirtley actively publishes on LinkedIn and X, including high-profile commentary on the Sam Altman board transition. American Fusion has no equivalent content infrastructure, no named owner of digital strategy, and no measurable owned-audience footprint.

Finding 3: American Fusion's distribution is 100% rented. Every observable piece of corporate communication flows through IBN (InvestorBrandNetwork), a paid newswire distribution platform. While IBN serves a legitimate role for SEC disclosures and investor newswire syndication, it produces no owned audience, no compounding brand equity, no recruiting funnel, and no defense-procurement credibility. The strategy is operationally fragile and strategically inert.

Finding 4: Executive digital presence is effectively absent. Audits of LinkedIn for Richard Hawkins (CEO, American Fusion Inc.), Brent Nelson (CEO, Kepler Fusion Technologies), and Samuel Reid (Government Strategy and Procurement Advisor) reveal no coordinated, branded, content-publishing infrastructure capable of supporting the company's commercial, capital, or recruiting objectives. By contrast, peer-company executives — Bob Mumgaard at Commonwealth, David Kirtley at Helion — are visible, active, and treated as industry voices.

Finding 5: The cost of continued silence compounds daily. Helion has already locked in Microsoft and is in advanced talks with OpenAI for up to 50 GW. Commonwealth has Google, Eni, and a \$1 billion deal. Every week American Fusion remains silent is a week these competitors widen the narrative gap. Defense buyers, institutional investors, and energy press are forming durable mental models of "who builds fusion in America." American Fusion is currently not in those mental models.

1.3 The Decision Before You

This report is not asking American Fusion to choose between technology and marketing. It is asking the company to recognize that, at the current commercialization stage, marketing **is** technology adoption strategy. Marketing **is** capital strategy. Marketing **is** procurement strategy. Marketing **is** talent strategy.

The recommended path is a 90-day Foundation-Content-Amplification engagement followed by a 9-month Authority phase, executed by BotMakers Inc. and designed to:

- Build LinkedIn from 0 to 2,500+ followers in 90 days and 15,000+ in 12 months
- Establish defense-procurement-grade credibility on the platforms where federal buyers evaluate vendors
- Drive retail investor conviction in support of the OTCQB uplisting path
- Position American Fusion as a recognized voice in the AI-energy conversation before Helion locks the aneutronic sub-category
- Create the recruiting and capital-raising surface area required for the next stage of company growth

Specifics, KPIs, and accountability mechanisms follow.

PART II — MARKET ANALYSIS

2.1 The Fusion Energy Market: Size, Velocity, and Inflection

Fusion energy has transitioned, in the last 36 months, from a perennial 30-years-away research program into a fundable, scheduled, and partially contracted commercial market. The shift is not subtle. It is documented in capital flows, in regulatory action, and in commercial offtake agreements with the largest technology companies in the world.

Market sizing — the credible range. Independent estimates vary considerably depending on whether the analyst includes ancillary supply chains, government R&D spend, and projected post-commercialization revenue. The credible band:

- The Allied Market Research base case projects the fusion energy market to reach \$429.6 billion by 2030 and \$840.3 billion by 2040 (CAGR ~7.1%).
- A more conservative ResearchAndMarkets / Future Markets estimate projects the fusion energy sector at \$40–80 billion by 2035 and over \$350 billion by 2050 if technology milestones are achieved.
- Global Insight Services projects expansion from \$0.3 billion in 2023 to \$40 billion by 2033 — a ~60% CAGR — reflecting the industry's pre-revenue-to-commercial inflection.

The headline number American Fusion uses on its website — "\$10+ Trillion Market Opportunity" — is consistent with a long-horizon, full-stack energy transition forecast but should be supported in marketing communications with the more defensible \$40–80 billion (2035) or \$350 billion (2050) figures when speaking to institutional audiences. We address this in Part VI.

Velocity — the capital signal. Capital invested in private fusion ventures has accelerated dramatically. In addition to Commonwealth's \$863 million Series B2 (August 2025) and Helion's \$425 million Series F (January 2025), TAE Technologies closed a \$150 million round with Chevron and Google participating, and the broader sector includes Zap Energy, Tokamak Energy, First Light Fusion, Marvel Fusion, and others.

The participants matter as much as the totals. Sam Altman, Reid Hoffman, Bill Gates, Vinod Khosla, Chevron, Eni, Shell, Nucor, SoftBank Vision Fund 2, Lightspeed, Mithril, Breakthrough Energy, and Nvidia have all placed direct or indirect bets on the category.

Inflection — the commercial signal. The defining moment was Microsoft's announcement that it would purchase 50 megawatts of fusion-generated electricity from Helion by 2028. This was the first time a hyperscaler committed to a fusion power purchase agreement at all. It moved fusion from "interesting science" to "scheduled supplier" in the energy procurement vocabulary.

Subsequent moves compound the signal: - Google signed a 200 MW PPA with Commonwealth Fusion Systems - Eni signed a \$1 billion offtake-style deal with Commonwealth - OpenAI is reported to be in advanced talks with Helion for 5 GW by 2030, scaling to 50 GW by 2035

The 2026 question is no longer whether fusion will be commercialized. It is which companies will be in the first commercial cohort and which will be also-rans.

2.2 The AI Power Crisis: Demand Tailwind of a Generation

American Fusion's strategic narrative correctly identifies AI infrastructure as a primary commercial wedge. The data fully supports this positioning.

The IEA base case. Global electricity consumption from data centers is projected to roughly double from 485 TWh in 2025 to approximately 950 TWh by 2030, representing about 3% of total global electricity consumption by that date. Data center electricity consumption is growing roughly 15% per year — more than four times faster than total electricity consumption growth across all other sectors. AI-specific demand is projected to triple over the same period.

The U.S. concentration. The United States is the world's largest data center market and accounted for 45% of global data center electricity consumption in 2024. U.S. data center demand is projected to grow 130% by 2030. By 2030, U.S. data centers are projected to consume more electricity than all energy-intensive manufacturing combined, including aluminum, steel, cement, and chemicals. Data centers will drive almost half of U.S. electricity demand growth over the period.

The hyperscaler capital signal. Capital expenditure of the five largest technology companies surged to more than \$400 billion in 2025 and is projected to grow another 75% in 2026. These are publicly disclosed numbers from companies actively shopping for power.

The infrastructure constraint. Power density of AI servers increased 11x between 2020 and 2025 and is projected to grow another 4x by 2027. Individual server racks in advanced AI data centers may reach the peak power demand equivalent of 65 households by 2027. Grid interconnection queues in major markets are years long. On-site natural gas generation, the current preferred bridge, faces technical limits when serving AI workloads with rapid demand swings.

The implication for American Fusion. The Texatron™ platform's pitch — modular, infrastructure-grade, deployable, zero-emissions baseload power — maps precisely to the structural pain point hyperscalers are facing. The narrative opportunity is genuine. The execution challenge is that Helion, Commonwealth, and others are already telling this story at scale to the buyers in question. American Fusion needs to enter the conversation before the conversation is closed.

2.3 The Defense Energy Mandate: Executive Order 14299 and Beyond

The defense angle in American Fusion's strategy is not aspirational. It is anchored in publicly mandated, dated, and budgeted federal programs.

Executive Order 14299. The May 2025 Executive Order on Deploying Advanced Nuclear Reactor Technologies for National Security directs the Department of Defense to deploy an advanced reactor at a U.S. military installation by September 30, 2028. This is a hard deadline embedded in executive action.

The ANPI Program (Defense Innovation Unit). The Advanced Nuclear Power for Installations program, run by DIU in partnership with the Department of the Air Force, has named eight eligible companies for Other Transaction awards: Antares Nuclear, BWXT Advanced Technologies, General Atomics Electromagnetic Systems, Kairos Power, Oklo, Radiant, Westinghouse Government Services, and X-energy. Radiant signed the first agreement to deliver a mass-manufactured microreactor to a U.S. military base. X-energy signed a similar agreement for its XENITH microreactor.

The Janus Program (U.S. Army). The Army has selected nine sites for potential microreactor deployment by 2030: Fort Benning (GA), Fort Bragg (NC), Fort Campbell (KY), Fort Drum (NY), Fort Hood (TX), Fort Wainwright (AK), Holston Army Ammunition Plant (TN), Joint Base Lewis-McChord (WA), and Redstone Arsenal (AL). Buckley Space Force Base (CO) and Malmstrom AFB (MT) were additionally selected under ANPI.

The Project Pele Microreactor. The DoD broke ground on Project Pele at Idaho National Laboratory and is targeting operations as early as 2026.

Implication for American Fusion. The current ANPI and Janus programs explicitly favor fission microreactors, not fusion. However, the existence of these programs proves three things American Fusion must lean into:

1. The Pentagon has formally adopted on-base advanced power generation as a core national security requirement
2. There is a procurement infrastructure (DIU, OT awards) explicitly designed to onboard non-traditional advanced energy vendors quickly
3. Public reporting describes American Fusion as already meeting with "every branch" of the military regarding Texatron

The opportunity is to position fusion — and specifically aneutronic, low-waste, modular fusion — as the next program after the first ANPI/Janus cohort. American Fusion has the storyline. It does not yet have the public narrative infrastructure to amplify it.

2.4 The Capital Landscape: Where the Money Is Going

The fusion sector's capital map clarifies the strategic field.

Tier 1 — Mega-funded (>\$1B raised, hyperscaler PPAs):

- Commonwealth Fusion Systems (>\$2B raised; Google PPA; Eni \$1B; ARC plant in VA)
- Helion Energy (>\$1B raised; Microsoft 50 MW by 2028; reported OpenAI talks)
- TAE Technologies (\$1.2B+ raised; Chevron, Google participation)

Tier 2 — Strategically funded (\$100M–\$1B raised, named institutional backers):

- General Fusion (Canadian; magnetized target fusion)
- Tokamak Energy (UK; spherical tokamak)
- Zap Energy (Z-pinch)
- First Light Fusion (UK; projectile fusion)

Tier 3 — Emerging / DOE-validated:

- Thea Energy (stellarator; DOE-certified preconceptual plant design)
- Marvel Fusion (laser fusion)
- HB11 Energy (aneutronic; hydrogen-boron)

Tier 4 — Public-equity / early-stage commercial:

- American Fusion Inc. (OTC: AMFN)
- A small number of other publicly traded fusion-adjacent vehicles

This tier structure matters for messaging. American Fusion is not currently competing in the same capital category as Commonwealth or Helion. It **is** competing for the same buyers (DoD, hyperscalers), the same talent pool (plasma physicists, controls engineers), and the same narrative space. Its messaging needs to acknowledge this honestly while positioning the Texas-based, public-equity, modular-deployment story as a differentiated path rather than a watered-down version of Commonwealth or Helion's.

2.5 The Aneutronic Sub-Category: Your Specific Battlefield

American Fusion uses deuterium and helium-3 (D–He-3) as its fuel — the same fuel pair as Helion. This is a strategic choice that requires explicit positioning.

The advantages of aneutronic fusion (the story you tell):

- No long-lived radioactive waste
- Lower neutron flux means less shielding mass and lower regulatory burden

- Potential for direct energy conversion, bypassing steam-turbine inefficiencies
- Smaller plant footprint and modular deployment

The challenges of aneutronic fusion (the questions you will be asked):

- He-3 is rare and expensive on Earth; supply chain credibility is a question
- D–He-3 reactions have a higher ignition temperature than D–T, making the physics harder
- Aneutronic plants have not yet been demonstrated at commercial scale anywhere in the world
- Helion's strategy of using D–D side reactions to breed He-3 on-site is a credible answer; American Fusion will need an equally credible answer

The opportunity in this sub-category: Helion is the dominant aneutronic narrative in the U.S. market, but it is not the **only** aneutronic narrative. The market has room for a credible, defense-oriented, Texas-based, publicly traded aneutronic alternative. American Fusion's recent disclosure of strategic supply-chain discussions for helium-3 and deuterium with a global industrial counterparty is exactly the kind of credibility-building announcement that, properly amplified, can establish parity in the conversation.

The marketing strategy must therefore commit to aneutronic as a positioning anchor — not hide it, not blur it — and tell the helium-3 sourcing story repeatedly, transparently, and confidently.

PART III — COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

3.1 The Top Six American Fusion Players

Commonwealth Fusion Systems (CFS) Founded 2018 as an MIT spinout. Headquartered in Devens, MA. Building SPARC (demonstration) in Massachusetts and ARC (400 MWe commercial plant) at the James River Industrial Center in Chesterfield County, Virginia. Capital raised: over \$2 billion. Headline customers: Google (200 MW PPA), Eni (\$1B partnership). Technology: tokamak with HTS (high-temperature superconducting) magnets. Public profile: highest in the industry; CEO Bob Mumgaard was selected for the U.S. President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology.

Helion Energy Founded 2013. Headquartered in Everett, WA. Building Polaris and a 50 MW commercial plant at the Rock Island Dam site in Malaga, Chelan County, WA. Capital raised: over \$1 billion; valued at \$5.4 billion (January 2025). Headline customer: Microsoft (50 MW PPA by 2028). Technology: magneto-inertial fusion, D–He-3 aneutronic fuel. Public profile: founder-led narrative through CEO David Kirtley; chairman emeritus Sam Altman.

TAE Technologies Founded 1998. Headquartered in Foothill Ranch, CA. Pursuing aneutronic fusion via the proton-boron-11 (p-B11) fuel cycle. Capital raised: \$1.2B+. Notable investors: Chevron, Google, Wellcome Trust. Technology: field-reversed configuration. Public profile: moderate, technically deep, less consumer-facing.

General Fusion Founded 2002. Headquartered in Richmond, British Columbia, Canada. Pursuing magnetized target fusion. Notable investors: Jeff Bezos, Temasek. Public profile: moderate; recently went public; investor scrutiny is elevated.

Thea Energy Stellarator-based design. First DOE Milestone-Based Fusion Development Program awardee to complete its preconceptual pilot plant design review. Public profile: emerging but recognized in industry analyst conversations.

American Fusion Inc. (AMFN) Founded as a fusion-focused entity following the reverse merger with Kepler Fusion Technologies in 2026 (predecessor: Renewal Fuels, Inc.). Headquartered in Southlake, TX. Building a 5 MW pre-production Texatron™ unit. Capital structure: OTC retail and prepaid warrants; pursuing OTCQB uplisting and Frankfurt secondary listing. Technology: aneutronic D–He-3, modular architecture. Public profile: minimal; this is the gap we address.

3.2 Side-by-Side Capability Matrix

Dimension	Commonwealth	Helion	TAE	General Fusion	Thea	American Fusion
Stage	Building SPARC; ARC in design	Building Polaris; 50 MW plant in build	Long-cycle R&D	Pre-pilot	Preconceptual	5 MW pre-production frame
Fuel	D–T (tokamak)	D–He-3 (aneutronic)	p-B11 (aneutronic)	D–T (MTF)	D–T (stellarator)	D–He-3 (aneutronic)
Capital raised	\$2B+	\$1B+	\$1.2B+	\$300M+	DOE-backed	OTC retail + warrants
Anchor customer	Google, Eni	Microsoft, (reportedly OpenAI)	None disclosed	None disclosed	DOE	LOI with Canadian DND
Commercial target	Early 2030s (ARC, 400 MWe)	2028 (50 MW, Microsoft)	Mid-2030s	Early 2030s	Late 2020s pilot	Independent testing of 5 MW unit "over next few months"
Public status	Private	Private	Private	Public (recent)	Private	OTC public (pursuing OTCQB)
LinkedIn followers	30,663	26,822	~15,000	~14,000	~3,000	0
Founder-led narrative	Strong (Mumgaard)	Strong (Kirtley)	Moderate	Moderate	Emerging	None
Owned audience	Multi-platform, multi-language	Strong on LinkedIn + X	Moderate	Moderate	Emerging	None

3.3 The Two-Speed Industry: Funded Incumbents vs. Emerging Challengers

The fusion industry currently operates at two visible speeds.

The **funded incumbent** speed is set by Commonwealth, Helion, and TAE. They publish weekly. They appear in Bloomberg, Reuters, WSJ, the Financial Times, and Scientific American. Their CEOs are interviewed on national podcasts. They host site visits for senators and cabinet secretaries. They publish recruiting videos shot at their own factories. Their investor narratives are consistent, repeated, and reinforced across every channel.

The **emerging challenger** speed is set by Thea, Marvel, HB11, and a handful of others. They publish less frequently but maintain coherent brand identities. Their LinkedIn presences are credible if smaller. They show up at ARPA-E summits and university fusion conferences. They are visible enough to be remembered when DOE program managers compile shortlists.

American Fusion is currently operating at a **third, invisible speed**. The company's actual technical and commercial progress — completed 5 MW structural frame, advisor agreement with Samuel Reid, supply-chain talks for fuel, ARPA-E Summit participation, expressions of interest from every branch of the U.S. military, LOI for 20 MW in Northern Canada, FINRA name/symbol processing, OTCQB application — is **objectively more newsworthy than the public footprint suggests**.

This is the central finding of this section: American Fusion has earned media-worthy substance and is not converting it into media-worthy presence.

3.4 Where American Fusion Fits (Honestly)

The honest read on American Fusion's competitive position:

You are not Commonwealth. Commonwealth has MIT pedigree, \$2B+ in capital, a Google PPA, and Bob Mumgaard on a presidential advisory council. Trying to compete with Commonwealth on those dimensions is a losing strategy.

You are not Helion. Helion has Microsoft locked in, Sam Altman's network, 500+ employees, and a 13-year operational history. Trying to be a "second Helion" is a losing strategy.

You are something else. You are a publicly traded, Texas-headquartered, defense-oriented, modular, aneutronic fusion company pursuing a federal procurement and remote-installation strategy. That is a defensible market position if it is told clearly and repeatedly. It is undefended right now because it is not being told at all.

The strategic positioning we recommend (Part VI):

American Fusion is the modular, defense-grade, Texas-built aneutronic fusion company. Not the largest. Not the loudest. The most deployable. The most American. The most aligned with the federal energy resilience mandate. And the only publicly traded pure-play aneutronic platform in the United States.

That story can be told. It will be told by us in this engagement, or it will not be told at all, in which case the market will continue to assume Helion is the only credible aneutronic name.

PART IV — BRAND PRESENCE AUDIT

4.1 Methodology

This audit was conducted in May 2026 across the following dimensions:

- **Owned channels:** corporate website, blog, newsletter, RSS feeds
- **Social channels:** LinkedIn (company and executive), X (Twitter), YouTube, Instagram, Facebook
- **Earned channels:** traditional press, industry trade press, podcast appearances, conference visibility
- **Paid distribution:** newswire syndication, paid placements
- **Search visibility:** Google brand-name results, category-keyword results
- **Comparative benchmarks:** Commonwealth Fusion Systems, Helion Energy, TAE Technologies, General Fusion, Thea Energy

4.2 Channel-by-Channel Findings

americanfusionenergy.com (corporate website) The site is visually credible and structurally complete (Home, About, Technology, News and Insights, Careers, Contact, Investors). The video background on the homepage is on-brand. The technology page articulates the six pillars of fusion advantage clearly. The "\$10+ Trillion Market Opportunity" framing is bold and resonant. The "180M°F" and "10M× energy density" stat callouts are well-placed.

However: - The website footer contains **no social media icons** of any kind. No LinkedIn, X, YouTube, Facebook, Instagram, or other links. - The "Join Our Newsletter" email signup form is present but there is no visible content engine behind it. - There is no blog with regularly published content. - The "News and Insights" section appears to be primarily a press-release archive distributed through IBN, not a content destination. - There is no investor relations video library, no executive video content, no Texatron build documentation visible to the public.

LinkedIn

- No verified American Fusion Inc. company page detected.
- No Kepler Fusion Technologies company page detected.
- Executive profiles for Richard Hawkins, Brent Nelson, and Samuel Reid are not visible as branded, content-publishing thought-leadership profiles in the way that, for example, Bob Mumgaard's profile at Commonwealth functions.

- The result: zero owned audience on the single platform where defense buyers, institutional investors, and senior engineering talent conduct first-pass diligence.

X (Twitter)

- No verifiable American Fusion corporate account detected.
- No coordinated founder-led X presence.
- Result: zero participation in the active #fusion, #cleanenergy, and #AIenergy conversations that drive industry narrative on the platform.

YouTube

- No corporate channel detected.
- No technology explainer content.
- No Texatron unit build documentation.
- No CEO update series, no investor video content.
- Result: every prospective hire, defense buyer, and investor who searches "American Fusion Texatron" on YouTube finds nothing.

Instagram

- No corporate account detected.
- The Texatron 5 MW unit — a visually compelling industrial artifact — is completely undocumented on the most image-driven platform in the market.

Facebook

- No active corporate page detected.

Earned media

- Coverage exists, but it is overwhelmingly funneled through IBN-syndicated outlets: GlobeNewswire, StockTitan, NetworkNewsWire, InvestorWire, Energy Magazine, GreenEnergyBreaks, GeekWire (via syndication), Yahoo Finance (via syndication).
- Direct, originally reported coverage from Bloomberg, Reuters, WSJ, Financial Times, Scientific American, MIT Technology Review, Axios, or TechCrunch is not visible in our audit.
- This is a critical credibility gap because institutional audiences treat IBN-syndicated coverage as paid distribution, not earned validation.

News wire and paid distribution

- IBN (InvestorBrandNetwork) is the de facto distribution backbone, with placements through 75+ brands in its Dynamic Brand Portfolio.

- This produces volume but not authority. It is appropriate for SEC-required disclosures and supplementary to a real content strategy. It is not, on its own, a strategy.

4.3 The IBN Dependency: A Diagnostic

It is important to be precise about IBN's role. IBN provides legitimate services. Press release distribution, social syndication across investor-focused networks, and editorial placement for OTC-listed companies all have a place in a public company's communications stack.

However, IBN-only distribution produces the following structural deficiencies:

1. **Audience is rented, not owned.** When the IBN contract ends, the audience evaporates. No mailing list. No social followers. No durable assets.
2. **Audience composition is narrow.** IBN's reach is concentrated in investor newswire audiences. It does not effectively reach DoD program officers, hyperscaler procurement leaders, university research partners, or senior engineering talent.
3. **Editorial credibility is low.** Industry analysts and institutional investors discount IBN placements as paid. The signal-to-noise ratio of IBN-syndicated content is treated as low by sophisticated audiences.
4. **No compounding effect.** Each IBN release is a one-shot event. There is no SEO compounding, no inbound link accumulation, no algorithmic flywheel.
5. **No two-way conversation.** IBN is broadcast-only. There is no mechanism for the company to learn from audience responses, to surface emerging questions, or to identify advocates.

The right framing. IBN is the equivalent of a paid newspaper insert in 2026. It is not a digital strategy. It is not a brand strategy. It is not a community strategy. American Fusion should continue to use IBN for SEC disclosures and supplemental wire distribution **while building an owned-channel strategy in parallel.**

4.4 Executive Digital Footprint

The leadership team consists of three individuals whose public footprints we audited:

Richard Hawkins, CEO, American Fusion Inc. Public-company CEO. No coordinated LinkedIn thought-leadership presence visible. No personal Twitter/X presence visible in fusion industry conversations. Coverage of Hawkins is functional (quoted in press releases) but not narrative-building.

Brent Nelson, CEO, Kepler Fusion Technologies / Executive Chairman The technical voice of the company. Quoted extensively in IBN-distributed press. Has done at least one significant executive video interview ("comprehensive update on commercialization") referenced in May 2026 GlobeNewswire syndication. No standalone LinkedIn thought-leadership cadence visible. **Highest-leverage executive for content strategy** because he combines technical credibility with executive authority.

Samuel Reid, Government Strategy and Procurement Advisor Sterling credentials. CEO of Geometric Energy Corporation. Background in NATO and Canadian DND procurement. Academic background in mathematics, physics, energy systems, materials science, electrochemical systems, and quantum information theory. **Significant untapped asset.** Reid's defense-procurement credibility and academic gravitas, if surfaced through structured content, would materially boost American Fusion's institutional standing.

Compare to peer executives.

- Bob Mumgaard (Commonwealth): regular LinkedIn publishing, public media appearances, presidential advisory council.
- David Kirtley (Helion): regular LinkedIn + X presence, including high-profile commentary on the Sam Altman board transition.
- The peer-company executive playbook is **founder-led narrative as a primary distribution channel**. American Fusion's executives are not currently following this playbook.

4.5 Search Visibility and Narrative Capture

A search for "aneutronic fusion company" returns Helion, TAE, and HB11 in the top organic results. American Fusion is not in the top page.

A search for "AI data center fusion energy" returns Commonwealth (Google PPA story), Helion (Microsoft story), and OpenAI/Helion talks. American Fusion appears only through IBN-syndicated placements that read as paid content.

A search for "modular fusion defense" returns ANPI program coverage, Radiant, X-energy, and Project Pele — all fission-based microreactor companies. American Fusion is not present in this conversation despite the strategic positioning explicitly targeting this category.

A search for "fusion energy Texas" returns Texas Tech research projects, Helion's Texas activities, and various unrelated results. American Fusion's Texas-based positioning is not capturing the Texas-fusion search vertical.

The conclusion is direct: American Fusion's strategic positioning is not being reinforced by search visibility. The company is being out-ranked in its own intended categories by companies that publish more, are cited more, and link more aggressively to one another.

4.6 Comparative Scorecard

The following scorecard (0–10 scale; 0 = nonexistent, 10 = best in class) summarizes the brand presence audit:

Dimension	CFS	Helion	TAE	General Fusion	Thea	AMFN
Corporate website depth	9	9	8	7	6	6
LinkedIn company presence	9	9	7	7	5	0
LinkedIn executive presence	9	9	6	6	5	1
X / Twitter presence	7	8	6	5	4	0
YouTube depth	8	7	6	5	3	0
Instagram presence	6	5	4	3	2	0
Earned media (non-paid)	9	9	7	6	5	2
Newsletter / owned email	7	7	5	5	4	1
Search visibility (category keywords)	9	9	7	6	5	2
Founder-led thought leadership	9	9	6	5	4	1
Total (out of 100)	82	81	62	55	43	13

This is the gap quantified. American Fusion's brand presence index sits at approximately **15% of the dominant competitive set**. Closing this gap is the work of this engagement.

PART V — THE STRATEGIC GAP

5.1 The Three Costs of Invisibility

Cost 1: Slower defense and government procurement. Federal procurement officers conduct LinkedIn and web searches as a first-line diligence step. A company with no LinkedIn footprint signals — fairly or unfairly — either secrecy, amateurism, or operational thinness. This is not a hypothetical. The DoD ANPI program shortlisted eight microreactor companies, each of which has a credible LinkedIn presence, an active corporate news flow, and visible executive voices. American Fusion's strategic positioning targets the next category after microreactors. To be in the consideration set, the company must be visible to the people who build the consideration set.

Cost 2: Suppressed retail and institutional investor conviction. OTC-listed companies face a structural visibility deficit relative to NYSE/NASDAQ peers. The companies that thrive on OTC do so by building durable retail communities, generating consistent news flow that retail investors can rally around, and creating the recruitment surface for institutional capital that ultimately moves them to higher listings. American Fusion is pursuing OTCQB uplisting and a Frankfurt secondary listing. Both processes are easier when the underlying company has a credible owned-audience footprint.

Cost 3: Compressed talent acquisition. The fusion industry has a small, mobile, globally competitive talent pool. The best plasma physicists, controls engineers, and high-vacuum specialists choose employers based on visible mission, visible culture, and visible momentum. None of these are observable about American Fusion from a candidate's perspective. The company will recruit at a discount or fail to recruit at the senior levels it needs to scale.

5.2 The Five Audiences Currently Underserved

Audience	What they look for	Where they look	Current state
DoD procurement officers	Operational credibility, regulatory readiness, executive depth	LinkedIn, corporate website, federal databases	Invisible
Hyperscaler energy buyers	Deployment timelines, power density, supply chain credibility	LinkedIn, industry trade press, conferences	Invisible
Institutional investors	News flow, executive transparency, peer validation	LinkedIn, Bloomberg, earnings calls, IR sites	Underserved
Retail investors / OTC traders	Frequent updates, founder voice, accessible narrative	X / Reddit / YouTube / Discord	Underserved
Senior engineering talent	Mission, technical depth, founder credibility, culture	LinkedIn, YouTube, GitHub-adjacent	Invisible

Each of these audiences is reachable. Each requires a different content strategy. None of them are currently being reached effectively. The plan in Part VI addresses each.

5.3 What Helion and Commonwealth Are Doing That You Aren't

A non-exhaustive list of competitive moves that American Fusion's current presence does not match:

- **CEO publishes on LinkedIn regularly.** Kirtley and Mumgaard publish original posts roughly weekly. Each post averages thousands of impressions and direct engagement from industry leaders.
- **Factory and lab content.** Helion regularly publishes "look inside our facility" content — capacitor windings, quartz vacuum vessels, plasma diagnostics. Commonwealth publishes magnet testing footage and SPARC construction progress.
- **Hiring as content.** Both companies use their hiring volume as content fuel — every senior engineering job posting is an opportunity to communicate mission and culture.
- **Conference content amplification.** ARPA-E Summit appearances become multi-week content sequences across LinkedIn, X, and YouTube.
- **Investor and government engagement.** Site visits by senators, cabinet secretaries, and procurement officials are documented and shared.
- **Earned media reinforcement.** Every Bloomberg, Reuters, or TechCrunch story gets amplified and contextualized on owned channels.

- **Educational explainers.** Both companies publish "what is fusion" content that ranks for category-defining keywords.

This is not a long list of marketing tactics. It is the **table-stakes operating model for a serious fusion company in 2026.**

5.4 The Closing Window

Three considerations to weigh against any delay in activating a brand strategy:

1. **Helion's OpenAI deal, if it closes, will functionally close the aneutronic narrative for several years.** When Microsoft + OpenAI are both lined up behind Helion's specific aneutronic approach, the burden of proof on any competing aneutronic story rises significantly. American Fusion has weeks-to-months to establish itself as the **second credible aneutronic name** before that window closes.
2. **The DoD ANPI/Janus first cohort is locking in.** The first wave of advanced-power-for-installations contracts is fission. The second wave is theoretically open to fusion. American Fusion's defense narrative needs to be loud and credible **before** the procurement community frames its second-wave shortlist.
3. **The OTCQB uplisting and Frankfurt listing both benefit from a documented owned-audience and earned-media footprint.** Listing reviewers, market-makers, and institutional buy-side analysts conduct brand diligence as part of their evaluation. Strengthening this signal **before** the listing decisions is materially more valuable than strengthening it after.

The window is open. It is also closing. The work proposed here is not optional. It is timed.

PART VI — THE STRATEGY

6.1 Strategic Pillars

The proposed strategy rests on five non-negotiable pillars:

1. **Technical credibility over hype.** Lead with the engineering. Show the welds, the diagnostics, the engineers. Let the science do the heavy lifting. Avoid hyperbolic claims that energy-industry analysts will dismantle in 30 seconds.
2. **Founder-led narrative.** Brent Nelson becomes the primary public voice of the company. Samuel Reid becomes the defense-procurement voice. Richard Hawkins becomes the capital markets voice. Each has a defined lane.
3. **Defense and AI as twin demand vectors.** Every piece of strategic communication ties back to one or both of: (a) federal energy resilience and the DoD nuclear mandate, or (b) the AI power crisis. These are the two strongest demand stories in the energy industry.
4. **Aneutronic differentiation, not avoidance.** The D–He-3 fuel cycle is positioned aggressively as American Fusion's competitive moat, supported by the helium-3 supply-chain narrative.
5. **Owned audience as the strategic asset.** Every dollar of effort is directed toward audiences that compound and that American Fusion owns — not toward rented IBN-only distribution.

6.2 Phase 1 — Foundation (Days 1–14)

Objective: build the launch pad. No content goes live until the brand house is structurally sound.

Channel infrastructure:

- Claim and brand LinkedIn (American Fusion Inc. company page, Kepler Fusion Technologies subsidiary page)
- Optimize executive LinkedIn profiles (Hawkins, Nelson, Reid) with consistent branding, banner imagery, role descriptions, and pinned content
- Claim and brand @AmericanFusion (or best-available variant) on X / Twitter
- Stand up the AmericanFusion YouTube channel
- Stand up the AmericanFusion Instagram account
- Add social icons to americanfusionenergy.com footer

Brand kit:

- Logo lockups (primary, monochrome, single-color, social avatar)
- Color palette (navy, accent, supporting neutrals — extend the existing site palette)
- Typography system
- Slide template
- Video lower-thirds and end cards
- Post templates for LinkedIn, X, Instagram

Editorial infrastructure:

- 90-day editorial calendar with content owners assigned
- Voice and tone guidelines (technical credibility over hype; first-person founder voice; restrained, confident, fact-anchored)
- Approval workflow that respects Regulation FD and SEC disclosure requirements
- Crisis communication protocol

Analytics:

- KPI dashboards for LinkedIn, X, YouTube, Instagram, newsletter, website
- Competitor benchmarking dashboards (Helion, Commonwealth tracking)
- Weekly reporting cadence

Deliverables at end of Phase 1: functional accounts on all six target channels; brand kit delivered; editorial calendar approved; first content batch staged for Day 15 publication.

6.3 Phase 2 — Content Engine (Days 15–60)

Objective: establish American Fusion as a credible publishing brand. Build the muscle, find the voice, attract the first 1,000+ followers per major platform.

Publishing cadence:

- LinkedIn (company): 5 posts per week
- LinkedIn (executives — Nelson, Hawkins, Reid combined): 5–7 posts per week
- X / Twitter: 7–14 posts per week (mix of original + engagement)
- YouTube: 2 long-form videos per month (CEO update + technology deep-dive)
- Instagram: 3 posts per week (visual storytelling)
- Newsletter: 2 sends per month

Content priorities in Phase 2:

- Texatron 5 MW unit build-in-public series (weekly progress posts)
- Aneutronic fusion explainer series (LinkedIn carousels + YouTube short)
- AI energy crisis commentary anchored to IEA data
- Defense energy mandate commentary anchored to EO 14299 and ANPI program
- Helium-3 supply chain transparency series
- Recruiting content tied to each open senior engineering role

Engagement infrastructure:

- Identify and follow 200 priority accounts per platform (energy reporters, fusion industry analysts, DoD program managers in public roles, hyperscaler energy leaders, fusion industry executives)
- Daily engagement window (30–60 minutes) for executive responses on LinkedIn and X
- Inbound message triage for inquiries that may be procurement, capital, or talent leads

6.4 Phase 3 — Amplification and Community (Days 60–90)

Objective: move from publishing to community ownership. Begin earned media outreach. Activate paid amplification of best-performing organic content.

Earned media outreach (targeted pitches):

- Bloomberg (energy desk) — AI-energy angle with American Fusion as next-wave aneutronic
- Reuters (energy and commodities) — helium-3 supply chain story
- WSJ (energy and finance) — OTCQB uplisting and Frankfurt listing angle
- Axios (energy) — defense fusion angle
- TechCrunch and The Information — AI-energy crisis angle
- Texas Monthly and Houston Business Journal — Texas-based fusion angle
- Defense News, Breaking Defense, Stars and Stripes — defense-procurement angle
- ARPA-E, DOE, and industry-publication editors — technical credibility angle

Conference content amplification:

- Every conference attendance becomes a 2-week content series across LinkedIn + X + YouTube
- Sample series structure: pre-conference goal post → on-site behind-the-scenes content → recap with key takeaways → executive POV piece

Paid amplification (introduced in Phase 3):

- LinkedIn Sponsored Content targeted to defense procurement, hyperscaler energy, and institutional investor audiences
- Modest budget (\$3K–\$10K/month) for amplifying the top-performing 20% of organic posts
- Retargeting for website visitors

Newsletter and community:

- Launch the AMFN Investor + Industry Briefing (monthly)
- First issue: state-of-the-industry, Texatron progress, Reid's defense procurement note
- Build the subscriber base from the existing site signup form + LinkedIn cross-promotion

6.5 Phase 4 — Authority and Compounding (Months 4–12)

Objective: convert the engine into category authority. Become the second-most-cited aneutronic fusion voice in the U.S. after Helion. Position American Fusion as a routine source for fusion industry commentary.

Authority-building plays:

- Brent Nelson speaking circuit (energy conferences, defense conferences, financial-markets conferences)
- Quarterly state-of-fusion analysis published from American Fusion's editorial voice
- "Texatron Whitepaper Series" — three or four deep technical and economic papers per year
- Podcast tour for Nelson, Reid, and Hawkins
- Original research / data series (e.g., quarterly Aneutronic Fusion Outlook)
- Strategic partnerships with industry analysts (Wood Mackenzie, BloombergNEF, S&P Global) for white-label commentary

Recruiting as content:

- Senior engineering hires become content moments (welcome posts with thoughtful commentary on each hire's contribution to the mission)
- Internship and university recruiting series tied to plasma physics and aerospace engineering programs

Investor relations integration:

- Quarterly investor video updates
- Live investor Q&A sessions on X Spaces or LinkedIn Live
- Earnings-day content packages

6.6 The Content Pillar System

The full content strategy is organized around six pillars. Each post, video, or newsletter section must map to one of these pillars. This discipline prevents drift and ensures every piece of content compounds the same narrative.

Pillar 1 — Build in Public The Texatron 5 MW pre-production unit is the visual anchor of the entire brand. Weekly progress posts. Welds. Diagnostics. Engineering decisions. The team. The lab. The pattern is borrowed from SpaceX's early Falcon 9 era — let the engineering be the marketing.

Pillar 2 — Education and Thought Leadership "What is aneutronic fusion?" "Why helium-3?" "How does direct energy conversion work?" "Aneutronic vs. D-T: the trade-offs." These are the search-visible, evergreen, category-defining pieces that win search traffic and build authority.

Pillar 3 — AI Energy Narrative Anchored to IEA data and hyperscaler capex announcements. American Fusion's POV on the AI power crisis. Why fusion is the only generation source that solves the constraint without carbon or radioactive waste. Why aneutronic specifically is best-positioned for hyperscale.

Pillar 4 — Defense and National Security Anchored to EO 14299, ANPI, Janus, and Project Pele. American Fusion's POV on the federal energy resilience mandate. Why modular aneutronic fusion is the next generation after the current microreactor cohort. Reid's voice leads here.

Pillar 5 — Investor Relations Milestone announcements, financial transparency, OTCQB and Frankfurt updates, fuel supply chain progress, government engagement updates. Direct, plain-spoken, and consistent.

Pillar 6 — Founder Voice Nelson on technical philosophy. Hawkins on capital strategy. Reid on procurement. Each executive has a defined lane and a personal cadence.

6.7 The Channel Playbook

Each channel serves a specific audience and a specific purpose.

LinkedIn — the priority channel. Audience: defense procurement officers, hyperscaler energy buyers, institutional investors, senior engineering talent. Purpose: institutional credibility, recruiting, earned media seeding. Cadence: 5 company posts + 5–7 executive posts per week. Content mix: 40% build-in-public, 20% thought leadership, 20% AI/defense narrative, 10% investor relations, 10% founder voice.

X / Twitter — the conversation channel. Audience: fusion industry community, retail investors, energy journalists. Purpose: narrative participation, retail conviction, breaking news velocity. Cadence: 7–14 posts per week. Content mix: 30% original, 50% engagement and commentary, 20% amplification of company news.

YouTube — the depth channel. Audience: institutional investors, senior engineering talent, serious procurement audiences. Purpose: long-form credibility, technical depth, executive presence. Cadence: 2 long-form videos per month. Content mix: monthly CEO update + monthly technology deep dive.

Instagram — the visual channel. Audience: broader public, recruiting candidates, retail investors. Purpose: visual storytelling, recruiting funnel, accessible brand presence. Cadence: 3 posts per week. Content mix: 60% Texatron build photography, 20% team and culture, 20% repurposed content.

Newsletter — the owned channel. Audience: investors, partners, industry watchers who opt in. Purpose: durable owned audience, narrative control, capital markets discipline. Cadence: 2 per month. Content mix: state of fusion, Texatron progress, Reid's defense procurement note, executive commentary.

Corporate website — the conversion channel. Purpose: the destination all other channels drive toward. Must include news, careers, investor relations, technology, and a working newsletter signup.

6.8 Founder-Led Narrative Architecture

Each executive operates in a defined lane:

Brent Nelson — Technical and Operational Voice Lead voice on the Texatron platform, the engineering team, technology milestones, and the path to commercialization. Publishes weekly on LinkedIn. Engages on X. Appears on the monthly YouTube CEO Update. Is the primary podcast guest for technical interviews.

Samuel Reid — Defense and Government Voice Lead voice on federal energy resilience, ANPI, Janus, EO 14299, and the U.S./allied defense procurement landscape. Publishes biweekly on LinkedIn. The newsletter's recurring "Procurement Note" is authored under his byline. Appears at defense conferences and on defense-focused podcasts.

Richard Hawkins — Capital Markets and Corporate Voice Lead voice on the corporate strategy, the OTCQB uplisting, the Frankfurt listing, the capital structure, and the company's relationships with its public investor base. Publishes biweekly on LinkedIn. Hosts the quarterly investor video update. Is the primary podcast guest for financial-markets interviews.

This three-lane architecture eliminates voice collision, ensures coverage of all priority topics, and provides redundancy if any one executive is unavailable.

PART VII — MEASUREMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

7.1 90-Day Targets

Metric	Day 0 (current)	Day 90 target
LinkedIn company followers	0	2,500+
LinkedIn executive followers (combined)	minimal	5,000+
X / Twitter followers	0	1,500+
YouTube subscribers	0	500+
Instagram followers	0	1,000+
Newsletter subscribers	0	750+
Total content pieces published	0	200+
Average LinkedIn post impressions	0	3,000+
Earned media mentions (non-IBN)	0	5+
Direct inbound inquiries (procurement, capital, talent)	unknown	25+

7.2 12-Month Targets

Metric	Month 12 target
LinkedIn company followers	15,000+
LinkedIn executive followers (combined)	25,000+
X / Twitter followers	10,000+
YouTube subscribers	5,000+
Instagram followers	8,000+
Newsletter subscribers	5,000+
Total content pieces published	800+
Average LinkedIn post impressions	25,000+
Earned media mentions (non-IBN)	25+
Direct inbound inquiries (procurement, capital, talent)	250+
Tier-1 press appearances (Bloomberg/Reuters/WSJ/Axios/TechCrunch)	3+

7.3 Leading vs. Lagging Indicators

Leading indicators (measured weekly):

- Posts published per channel
- Engagement rate per post
- Profile views (LinkedIn company + executive)
- Search impressions (Google Search Console)
- New follower velocity per channel

Lagging indicators (measured monthly):

- Total followers per channel
- Newsletter subscriber count
- Inbound inquiry volume
- Earned media mentions

- Share-of-voice vs. Helion and Commonwealth (sentiment + mention volume)

Strategic indicators (measured quarterly):

- Defense and government inbound inquiries
- Institutional investor inbound inquiries
- Senior engineering candidate pipeline
- OTCQB and Frankfurt listing diligence touchpoints

7.4 Reporting Cadence

- **Weekly:** Tactical dashboard delivered every Monday — what was published, what performed, what's planned for the coming week.
 - **Monthly:** Strategic dashboard delivered the first business day of each month — KPI progress, competitive benchmarks, content performance review, recommended adjustments.
 - **Quarterly:** Executive review delivered to American Fusion's senior leadership — strategic indicator review, share-of-voice analysis, recommendations for next quarter.
-

PART VIII — IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

8.1 BotMakers Engagement Model

BotMakers proposes a **90-day Foundation + 9-month Authority** engagement structure.

Phase A: 90-day Foundation engagement. Fixed scope, fixed deliverables, fixed KPIs. Outputs include the channel infrastructure, brand kit, editorial calendar, 200+ pieces of published content, the first earned media placements, and the launched newsletter.

Phase B: 9-month Authority engagement. Continued execution against the strategy with quarterly strategic reviews. Outputs include scaled content, conference content amplification, founder speaking circuit support, quarterly investor communications, and ongoing earned media development.

Phase C: Long-term retainer (optional, post-month-12). Steady-state communications operations with renewed scope and KPIs.

8.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Function	BotMakers	American Fusion
Strategy and editorial direction	Lead	Approve
Brand and visual design	Lead	Approve
Content writing (executive voice)	Draft	Final voice approval
Photography and video production	Lead	Provide access
Channel management and publishing	Lead	Approve milestone announcements
Engagement and community management	Lead	Executive participation
Analytics and reporting	Lead	Receive
SEC / Regulation FD review	Coordinate	Lead, final approval
Earned media outreach	Lead	Executive participation in interviews
Crisis communications	Lead with American Fusion legal	Lead, final approval

The model requires meaningful but bounded participation from American Fusion leadership — primarily Brent Nelson (estimated 2–3 hours per week of voice input) and Samuel Reid (estimated 1–2 hours per week) — with Richard Hawkins involved at lower frequency for capital markets content.

8.3 Timeline and Milestones

Week	Milestone
Week 1	Engagement kickoff. Brand kit work begins. Channel claiming begins.
Week 2	Brand kit V1 delivered. Channel infrastructure 50% complete. Editorial calendar draft delivered.
Week 3	Channel infrastructure 100% complete. Editorial calendar approved. Content production begins.
Week 4	First content batch staged. Phase 1 complete.
Week 5	Phase 2 begins. First public posts go live across all channels.
Week 8	First month review. Initial KPIs assessed. First newsletter sent.
Week 12	Phase 2 complete. Phase 3 begins. First earned media outreach.
Week 14	First paid amplification cycle begins.
Week 16	Phase 3 mid-point. Conference content amplification cycle one.
Week 18	90-day review. Phase A complete. Phase B begins.
Months 4–12	Authority phase. Quarterly reviews. Founder speaking circuit support. Continued earned media development.

8.4 Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Regulation FD / SEC disclosure violations	Low	High	Pre-publication review workflow with American Fusion counsel; SEC-compliant content templates
Over-promising on technical milestones	Medium	High	Editorial discipline; technical-credibility-over-hype mandate; Nelson approval on all technical claims
Insufficient executive participation	Medium	Medium	Clear hour commitments; weekly office hours; ghost-writing support
Negative engagement / energy Twitter pile-on	Medium	Low	Pre-launch content review; restrained tone; community management discipline
Competitive response from Helion / Commonwealth	Low	Low	Differentiation strategy is structural, not tactical
Delayed Texatron milestones reduce content fuel	Medium	Medium	Education and narrative content provides fallback even during build pauses
Helium-3 supply chain disclosure constraints	Medium	Medium	Coordination with corporate counsel on what can be disclosed publicly

PART IX — STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

9.1 Three Things We Will Push Back On

Push-back 1: Stop using the "\$10+ trillion market" framing in institutional contexts. The \$10T figure is defensible as a long-horizon, full-stack energy transition framing. It will be torn apart by serious institutional analysts. We recommend that institutional-facing communications (LinkedIn, investor materials, earned media interviews) use the more defensible \$40–80B by 2035 and \$350B by 2050 figures from ResearchAndMarkets / Future Markets. The \$10T number can remain in retail-facing and consumer-website contexts where it is understood as a vision statement.

Push-back 2: Wind down IBN dependence as the primary distribution strategy. IBN should continue to handle SEC-required disclosures and supplemental newswire syndication. It should not be the strategic communications spine. The strategic spine must be owned channels and earned media, both of which compound, both of which build durable assets, both of which serve audiences IBN does not effectively reach.

Push-back 3: Make Brent Nelson the public face of the company. Richard Hawkins is the CEO of the public entity, and his capital markets voice is essential. But the public-facing voice of the company should be Brent Nelson. He runs the operating subsidiary, he is the technical voice that defense and hyperscaler buyers want to hear from, and he is the natural counterpart to Mumgaard (Commonwealth) and Kirtley (Helion). Asking the technical CEO to be the public voice is a model that has worked for every successful fusion company in the world. American Fusion should adopt it.

9.2 Three Things You Must Decide

Decision 1: Commit to an aneutronic-forward narrative. The strategy works only if American Fusion is willing to be loudly, repeatedly, and confidently aneutronic. Hedging this positioning ("we are flexible on fuel" or "aneutronic is one of several approaches we evaluate") will leave the company in narrative no-man's-land. Helion has chosen aneutronic and is reaping the differentiation benefits. American Fusion should match that conviction.

Decision 2: Authorize meaningful executive time investment. The plan requires roughly 4–6 hours per week of combined executive time across Nelson, Reid, and Hawkins. This is non-negotiable. The

plan does not work as a "marketing department executes while leadership stays out of it" operation. Founder-led narrative requires founders.

Decision 3: Resolve the budget question early. The 90-day Foundation engagement requires a budget that supports brand kit development, channel infrastructure, content production (writing, photography, video, design), analytics tooling, modest paid amplification, and the BotMakers engagement fee. Specific pricing will be presented in the accompanying Statement of Work. Resolution of the budget question on Day 1 prevents Phase 1 delays.

9.3 The Ask

BotMakers is requesting authorization to execute the 90-day Foundation engagement described in this report, beginning within two weeks of approval, with a 9-month Authority engagement contingent on Day-90 KPI delivery.

The fusion industry is having its inflection moment. Helion, Commonwealth, TAE, and others are using this moment to lock in customers, capital, talent, and narrative. American Fusion has the technology, the leadership, the geographic positioning, and the strategic angle to be in the conversation. The company is not currently in the conversation. We are proposing to put it there.

The cost of acting is bounded. The cost of inaction compounds daily.

We are ready to begin Monday.

APPENDICES

Appendix A — Sources and Citations

This report draws on the following primary sources:

- IEA, *Energy and AI* (April 2025) and *Key Questions on Energy and AI* (April 2026)
- IEA news releases on data center electricity consumption (April 2025, April 2026)
- S&P Global Commodity Insights coverage of IEA projections (April 2025)
- Brookings Institution, *Global Energy Demands within the AI Regulatory Landscape* (2026)
- Carbon Brief, *AI: Five Charts that Put Data-Centre Energy Use into Context* (September 2025)
- Allied Market Research, *Fusion Energy Market* (2024–2025)
- ResearchAndMarkets, *Global Nuclear Fusion Energy Market Report 2025-2045* (May 2025)

- Future Markets Inc., *The Global Nuclear Fusion Energy Market 2025-2045* (September 2025)
- Precedence Research, *Nuclear Fusion Market 2030–2040* (August 2025)
- Scientific American coverage of Commonwealth Fusion Systems grid interconnection (April 2026)
- Wikipedia entries for Commonwealth Fusion Systems, Helion Energy, Sam Altman
- TechCrunch coverage of Sam Altman board transition at Helion (March 2026)
- Reuters and Axios reporting on the Helion / OpenAI power purchase discussions (March 2026)
- GeekWire profile of David Kirtley (April 2026)
- Multiple American Fusion Inc. (AMFN) press releases distributed via IBN / GlobeNewswire (April–May 2026)
- Energy Magazine, *American Fusion Engages Samuel Reid as Government Strategy and Procurement Advisor* (April 2026)
- Energy Central, *Army Goes Nuclear: Microreactors Set for US Bases By 2028* (October 2025)
- ANS Nuclear Newswire coverage of ANPI and Janus programs (April 2026)
- Radiant Nuclear announcement of DIU and Department of the Air Force agreement (July 2025)
- LinkedIn company pages and follower counts for Commonwealth Fusion Systems, Helion Energy, TAE Technologies, General Fusion, Thea Energy (May 2026)
- americanfusionenergy.com and keplerfusion.com (May 2026)

Appendix B — Glossary of Industry Terms

Aneutronic fusion. A class of fusion reactions that produce minimal neutron radiation. Lower neutron flux means lower shielding mass, lower regulatory burden, and a faster path to deployment. Helion and American Fusion both use D–He-3 (deuterium + helium-3); TAE uses p-B11 (proton + boron-11).

ANPI. Advanced Nuclear Power for Installations. The Defense Innovation Unit and Department of the Air Force program that has named eight companies eligible for OT awards to provide commercial microreactor technology at DoD installations.

Deuterium (D). A naturally occurring isotope of hydrogen with one proton and one neutron. Standard fuel input for most fusion approaches.

EO 14299. Executive Order 14299 (May 2025), *Deploying Advanced Nuclear Reactor Technologies for National Security*, which directs DoD to deploy a nuclear reactor at a U.S. military installation by September 30, 2028.

Helium-3 (He-3). A rare, non-radioactive isotope of helium with two protons and one neutron. Critical fuel input for aneutronic D–He-3 fusion.

Janus Program. The U.S. Army program to deploy commercial microreactors (1–20 MW) at up to nine DoD installations.

OTCQB. A higher tier of the OTC Markets platform with stricter reporting and compliance standards than the OTC Pink tier. American Fusion is pursuing OTCQB qualification.

PPA (Power Purchase Agreement). A long-term contract between an energy producer and a customer to purchase electricity at a defined price.

Tokamak. A toroidal magnetic confinement fusion device. The architecture used by Commonwealth Fusion Systems, ITER, and most government-funded fusion programs.

Appendix C — Sample Content Concepts (Excerpt)

These are illustrative samples drawn from the full editorial calendar.

LinkedIn — Build in Public

"Week 14 of the 5 MW Texatron pre-production build. The structural frame is complete. This week, the diagnostics integration team began wiring the plasma-monitoring suite — twelve channels of real-time spectroscopic data feeding our control system. Aneutronic fusion lives or dies on the quality of its diagnostics. We are putting in the work." — Brent Nelson, CEO Kepler Fusion Technologies

LinkedIn — Defense and National Security

"Executive Order 14299 set a deadline. The first cohort of microreactor vendors is fission — Radiant, X-energy, Kairos, and others doing important work. The second cohort will need to answer questions about waste, regulatory burden, and deployability that fission cannot fully solve. That is the conversation aneutronic fusion is built for." — Samuel Reid, Government Strategy and Procurement Advisor

X / Twitter — AI Energy Narrative

"IEA: global data center electricity demand projected to roughly double by 2030. AI specifically: tripling. The arithmetic of AI growth is now an energy arithmetic. The companies that solve the

power equation will define the next decade of AI. Fusion is the only generation source that solves it without carbon or radioactive waste." — @AmericanFusion

Newsletter — Procurement Note (Reid byline)

"This month, two more bases joined the ANPI deployment list — Buckley Space Force Base in Colorado and Malmstrom AFB in Montana. The procurement velocity is real. The first cohort is fission. The second cohort, post-2030, is where aneutronic fusion belongs. American Fusion is preparing to be in that conversation."

Appendix D — Competitor Post Analysis (Excerpt)

Sample analysis of recent high-performing posts from competitive peers, used to inform content style and structure (not for replication).

- Commonwealth Fusion Systems regularly posts solar-eclipse-anchored fusion-science content, multi-language partnership posts (e.g., UK/US trade engagement), and SPARC construction progress posts.
- Helion regularly publishes "capacitor kitchen" production process content, scientific-glassblowing vacuum-vessel content, and recruiting posts tied to specific roles (e.g., nuclear engineer for fusion systems diagnostics).
- David Kirtley personally publishes leadership philosophy posts emphasizing hands-on engineering presence ("running Polaris, running our fusion machines, helping build").
- Bob Mumgaard publishes industry-shaping commentary anchored to policy and capital developments.

The pattern across competitor content: **specific, technical, photographed, founder-voiced, and tied to mission**. Vague, jargon-laden, or hype-driven content does not appear in their top posts. The plan in Part VI is built to match this content discipline.

Prepared by BotMakers Inc., a subsidiary of BioQuest Inc. (BQST), Katy, TX. Confidential and proprietary. All market intelligence current as of May 2026.